

pending on the network location from where the pictures are coming in and the pictures themselves, the thief can be tracked down.

Bluetooth

If your laptop has bluetooth functionality, you can use it in various innovative ways.

To communicate with other devices. The inbuilt bluetooth functionality in laptops can be used to communicate with other bluetooth-capable

devices, including

laptops and mobile phones.

The communication modes include accessing files on the

phone from the laptop and vice-versa.

Files can be dragged and dropped between the two connected devices. This eliminates the need to search for LAN cables to connect laptops or for USB cable to connect your mobile phone. Apart from this, by using the Bluetooth functionality you can access the Internet on your laptop using the GPRS/Internet connection of your mobile phone, send or receive SMSs and even call from the laptop.

To convert your phone into an input device for your laptop. A bluetooth mobile phone can be used as an input device for the computer, i.e., as an additional keyboard. As such, while making presentations, slides can be advanced by pressing the keys on the phone, which is connected to your laptop via bluetooth connection. This gives you the freedom to move around and not carry any additional pointing device.

It is important to remember that when not using bluetooth, it's best to switch off the functionality to conserve power. This will ensure that the laptop's battery lasts longer. This can usually be done via a key combination indicated on your laptop keyboard or from the control panel of the operating system.

Wireless

Wireless networks these days are ubiquitous. These have helped us do away with the cables which interconnect computers and the ones which



connect to corporate intranets to access the Internet. It is important to be aware of the following points while accessing the Internet via wireless networks:

1. Connect only to those networks that you trust (e.g., your company network or your home network).

2. Connecting to unknown networks at coffee shops or elsewhere may put your username or password at risk, as wireless networks are easily hacked.

Also, as in the case of Bluetooth, when not using a wireless network it is best to turn-off the functionality to conserve power and extend the laptop's battery life. This can also be done via key combinations as well as from the network icon in the task bar or from the control panel.

Fingerprint scanner

Some laptops come with fingerprint scanners on them. If you have selected a laptop equipped with this functionality,



you can ease your login process by swiping your finger over the scanner instead of having to type the password at the login or unlock screens.

Like face or eye recognition for cameras, the system administrator can pre-configure the laptop with your fingerprint and associate it with your login, to ensure that whenever you swipe your finger, the operating system recognises your fingerprint and logs you in.

Some laptops can also lock the hard disk at shutdown and unlock it only if a pre-registered fingerprint is swiped. This helps in the prevention of data-theft when a laptop is stolen; the thief will not be able to access your data even by physically removing the hard disk from the laptop and attaching it to another system, as it will still remain locked.

Suspend and hibernate

Instead of shutting down the laptop each time you don't want to use it for an extended period of time you can put it into 'suspend' mode. It puts almost all of the laptop's hardware to



sleep, except the memory. This means the laptop uses very little power in this state. When the laptop is started again it resumes from the point you had last left it. This ensures you can resume your work as you left it, instead of re-opening documents and presentations as you would normally have to do after a restart, or a shutdown and start. It is completely safe to keep the laptop in the suspended state overnight or on long travels. This saves a lot of time that would usually be spent in restarting the laptop and resuming work.

'Hibernate' is a special mode of suspend in which the laptop is com-